

Internet - China

AI Watch: What to expect from Zhipu & Minimax results

Industry Overview

Zhipu: all eyes on ARR guidance, compute tightness easing

Zhipu is due to report 1H26 on Aug 31 after HK close. We expect 1H26 total revenue to reach 782m RMB vs. 533m RMB in 2H25, with full year 26 total revenue to grow significantly to 3.4bn RMB (370% YoY), driven by rapid cloud-based deployment revenue. With Zhipu completing 4bn USD equity-raise in early July and subsequently investing aggressively in compute resource, its compute tightness has notably eased, evidenced by now full availability of its coding plan domestically. **Our view:** while China model competition landscape remains fluid, we believe Zhipu is in a period of harvesting given top-notch GLM5.3 model capability, and more importantly, it currently leads competitors on funding and compute which translate into faster post-training iteration and more immediate inference revenue. **Key things to look for in the earnings call:** 1) ARR guidance (consensus now at 2.5-3bn USD by 26 year-end); 2) inference margin outlook; 3) thoughts on training cost as it further scales. Maintain Buy and PO of HKD1250.

MiniMax: M3.1 & M3 Pro timeline key focus

MiniMax is due to report 1H26 on Aug 26 after HK close. We expect 1H26 total revenue to reach 80m USD vs. 48m USD in 2H25, with full year 26 total revenue to grow significantly to 383m USD (385% YoY), driven by rapid cloud-based deployment revenue. **Our view:** after sell-off in June/July due to model upgrade hiccup and lock-up expiration, our previous catch-up thesis for MiniMax has materialized thanks to Southbound support and H3 model upgrade. **Key things to look for in the earnings call:** 1) ARR guidance (consensus now at 1-1.5bn USD by 26 year-end); 2) video-generation model H3 recent performance post major upgrade; 3) post-training focused model upgrade (M3.1) and M3 Pro launch timeline. Maintain Buy and PO of HKD500.

24 August 2026

Equity
China
Internet/e-Commerce

Alex Liu >>
Research Analyst
Merrill Lynch (Hong Kong)
+852 3508 5090
alex.liu3@bofa.com

Miranda Zhuang, CFA >>
Research Analyst
Merrill Lynch (Hong Kong)
miranda.zhuang@bofa.com

Joyce Ju >>
Research Analyst
Merrill Lynch (Hong Kong)
joyce.ju@bofa.com

Joanna Du >>
Research Analyst
Merrill Lynch (Hong Kong)
joanna.du@bofa.com

Abbreviations are found at Exhibit 1

Table 1: We expect a series of key events to impact major China AI players

Key sector/company events ahead and implications to major AI players in China

Time	Event	Potential Impacts
Late Aug	Zhipu/MiniMax: 1H26 results	
Sep	Alibaba: potential model upgrade (Qwen 4.0) during Sep Alibaba Cloud Summit	- MiniMax/Zhipu: Negative, more intense competition - Tencent: Negative, more intense competition
Sep-Oct	MiniMax: potential launch of M3 Pro	- Zhipu: Negative, more intense competition
Sep-Oct	Tencent: potential launch of HY4 preview	- MiniMax/Zhipu: mild negative, more intense competition - Alibaba: mild negative, more intense competition on cloud
2H26	Zhipu: potential launch of GLM5.5	- MiniMax: Negative, more intense competition
2H26	DeepSeek: potential launch of V5	- MiniMax/Zhipu: Negative, more intense competition
4Q26	Bytedance: potential launch of Seed model series upgrade	- MiniMax/Zhipu: Negative, more intense competition - Alibaba: mild negative, more intense competition on cloud
7-Jan-27	Zhipu: 12-month lock-up expiry	- Zhipu: Negative, ~40% shares unlocked
8-Jan-27	MiniMax: 12-month lock-up expiry	- MiniMax: Negative, 90% shares unlocked post this event

Source: Company, BofA Global Research estimates

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

>> Employed by a non-US affiliate of BofAS and is not registered/qualified as a research analyst under the FINRA rules.

Refer to "Other Important Disclosures" for information on certain BofA Securities entities that take responsibility for the information herein in particular jurisdictions.

BofA Securities does and seeks to do business with issuers covered in its research reports. As a result, investors should be aware that the firm may have a conflict of interest that could affect the objectivity of this report. Investors should consider this report as only a single factor in making their investment decision.

Refer to important disclosures on page 5 to 8. Analyst Certification on page 3. Price Objective Basis/Risk on page 2.

13011117

Timestamp: 23 August 2026 06:28PM EDT

Exhibit 1: Glossary of abbreviations

Abbreviations and definition

Term	Definition
AA	Artificial Analysis
AA-LCR	Artificial Analysis Long Context Reasoning
AI infra	AI infrastructure
API	Application programming interface
ARR	Annual Recurring Revenue
CLI	Command-line interface
CritPt	Complex Research using Integrated Thinking – Physics Test
ECI	Epoch Capabilities Index
GDPval-AA	GDPval-Artificial Analysis
GLM	General Language Model (Zhipu's GLM model family)
GPQA	Graduate-Level Google-Proof Q&A benchmark
GPU	Graphics processing unit
HLE	Humanity's Last Exam
HY	Hunyuan
IaaS	Infrastructure as a service
IFBench	Instruction Following Benchmark
IM	Instant messaging
LLM	Large language model
MaaS	Model-as-a-Service
MoE	Mixture of experts
OEM	Original equipment manufacturer
P/ARR	Price to annual recurring revenue
PaaS	Platform as a service
PCAOB	Public Company Accounting Oversight Board
SciCode	Research coding benchmark curated by scientists
SCMP	South China Morning Post
SOTA	State of the art
SWE	Software Engineering
VAS	Value-added services
VAT	Value-added tax

Source: BofA Global Research

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

Exhibit 2: Stocks mentioned

Prices and ratings for stocks mentioned in this report

BofA Ticker	Bloomberg ticker	Company name	Price	Rating
KATJF	2513 HK	Knowledge Atlas Tech	HK\$ 1129	C-1-9
MNMXF	100 HK	MiniMax	HK\$ 347.2	C-1-9

Source: BofA Global Research

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

Price objective basis & risk**Knowledge Atlas Technology (KATJF)**

Our PO of HKD1,250 is based on a DCF methodology, reflecting strong expected revenue growth and gradual margin improvement from scaling API monetization and cloud deployment. We assume 2.0% risk-free rate, 6.0% market premium, 20% debt to asset ratio, 15% tax rate, beta of 1.5, and 4.0% terminal growth rate in our DCF model, resulting in 11% cost of equity and 9.7% WACC.

Upside risks: faster-than-expected enterprise and public-sector adoption, stronger API monetization and pricing power, accelerated cloud penetration, improved inference efficiency driving margin upside.

Downside risks: weaker-than-expected enterprise demand or monetization, slower cloud/API adoption, compute supply constraints inflating costs, intensifying competition impacting pricing and margins, lockup expiration in July 2026 and January 2027.

MiniMax (MNMXF)

Our PO of HKD500 is based on a DCF methodology, reflecting strong expected revenue growth and gradual margin improvement from scaling AI-native monetization and API expansion. We assume 2.0% risk-free rate, 6.0% market premium, 20% debt-to-asset ratio, 15% tax rate, beta of 1.5, and 4.0% terminal growth rate in our DCF model, resulting in 11% cost of equity and 9.7% WACC.

Upside risks: faster-than-expected user and enterprise adoption, stronger monetization from AI-native applications, accelerated API penetration, improved inference efficiency driving margin upside potential.

Downside risks: weaker-than-expected user growth or monetization, slower API adoption, rising compute costs, intensifying competition impacting pricing and margins, lockup expiration.

Analyst Certification

I, Alex Liu, hereby certify that the views expressed in this research report accurately reflect my personal views about the subject securities and issuers. I also certify that no part of my compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or view expressed in this research report.

APR - Internet, Media and Software Coverage Cluster

Investment rating	Company	BofA Ticker	Bloomberg symbol	Analyst
BUY				
	Agora	API	API US	Daley Li, CFA
	Alibaba Group	BABA	BABA US	Joyce Ju
	Alibaba Group	BABAF	9988 HK	Joyce Ju
	Alibaba Health	ALBHF	241 HK	Miranda Zhuang, CFA
	Baidu.com	BIDU	BIDU US	Miranda Zhuang, CFA
	Baidu.com	BAIDF	9888 HK	Miranda Zhuang, CFA
	Bilibili	BILI	BILI US	Alex Liu
	Bilibili	BLBLF	9626 HK	Alex Liu
	CAR Group	CRSLF	CAR AU	Sriharsh Singh
	Coupang	CPNG	CPNG US	Ahyung Cho
	Damai Entertainment	ABPGF	1060 HK	Harry Zhuang
	Delhivery	XDVLF	DELHIVER IN	Sachin Salgaonkar
	East Money	XEQTF	300059 CH	Michael Li
	Eternal	XMWRF	ETERNAL IN	Sachin Salgaonkar
	Grab Holdings	GRAB	GRAB US	Sachin Salgaonkar
	HYBE	XBGOF	352820 KS	Sun Jung Lee
	JD Health	JDHIF	6618 HK	Miranda Zhuang, CFA
	JD Industrials	XJHIF	7618 HK	Miranda Zhuang, CFA
	JD.com	JD	JD US	Joyce Ju
	JD.com	JDCMF	9618 HK	Joyce Ju
	KE Holdings	BEKE	BEKE US	Miranda Zhuang, CFA
	KE Holdings	XSQRF	2423 HK	Miranda Zhuang, CFA
	Kingdee International Software	KGDEF	268 HK	Daley Li, CFA
	Kingsoft Cloud	KC	KC US	Daley Li, CFA
	Kingsoft Cloud	KCLHF	3896 HK	Daley Li, CFA
	Kingsoft Office	XBKOF	688111 CH	Daley Li, CFA
	Knowledge Atlas Technology	KATJF	2513 HK	Alex Liu
	Krafton	XKINF	259960 KS	Jinhan Chun
	Kuaishou	KUASF	1024 HK	Miranda Zhuang, CFA
	Life360	LIFX	360 AU	Sriharsh Singh
	Makemytrip Limited	MMYT	MMYT US	Sachin Salgaonkar
	Meitu Inc.	MEIUF	1357 HK	Harry Zhuang
	MiniMax	MNMXF	100 HK	Alex Liu
	NAVER Corporation	NHNCF	035420 KS	Ahyung Cho
	NetEase	NETTF	9999 HK	Alex Liu
	NetEase, Inc	NTES	NTES US	Alex Liu
	Paytm	XUXBF	PAYTM IN	Sachin Salgaonkar
	Plan B Media PCL	XMKTF	PLANB TB	Suppamong Iemkongaek, CFA, CMT
	Sea Limited	SE	SE US	Sachin Salgaonkar
	Seek Limited	SKLTF	SEK AU	Sriharsh Singh
	Tencent Holdings	TCTZF	700 HK	Alex Liu
	The ONE Enterprise	XUFCF	ONEE TB	Suppamong Iemkongaek, CFA, CMT
	Tongcheng Travel	TNGCF	780 HK	Joyce Ju
	Trip.com Group	TCOM	TCOM US	Joyce Ju
	Trip.com Group	TRPCF	9961 HK	Joyce Ju
	TUHU Car	XTCRF	9690 HK	Miranda Zhuang, CFA
	Vipshop Holdings	VIPS	VIPS US	Joyce Ju
	Xero Limited	XROLF	XRO AU	Sriharsh Singh
	Zip Co Limited	ZIZTF	ZIP AU	Ware Kuo
NEUTRAL				
	Chinasoft International	CFTLF	354 HK	Daley Li, CFA
	GoTo Group	GTOFF	GOTO IJ	Sachin Salgaonkar
	Hundsun Technologies	XYTGF	600570 CH	Daley Li, CFA
	Info Edge	IFOEF	INFOE IN	Sachin Salgaonkar
	JYP Entertainment	ALNNF	035900 KS	Sun Jung Lee
	Kakao Corp.	DAUCF	035720 KS	Ahyung Cho
	Kanzhun Ltd.	XKLRF	2076 HK	Miranda Zhuang, CFA
	Kanzhun Ltd.	BZ	BZ US	Miranda Zhuang, CFA
	Kingsoft Corporation	KSFTF	3888 HK	Daley Li, CFA
	Maoyan Entertainment	MAOFF	1896 HK	Harry Zhuang
	Meituan	MPNGF	3690 HK	Joyce Ju
	Ming Yuan Cloud	XWTAF	909 HK	Daley Li, CFA
	NC	NCSCF	036570 KS	Jinhan Chun

APR - Internet, Media and Software Coverage Cluster

Investment rating	Company	BofA Ticker	Bloomberg symbol	Analyst
	Nykaa	XQQGF	NYKAA IN	Sachin Salgaonkar
	PB Fintech	XPFXF	POLICYBZ IN	Sachin Salgaonkar
	Pinduoduo Inc.	PDD	PDD US	Joyce Ju
	REA Group	RPGRF	REA AU	Sriharsh Singh
	SM Entertainment	SMEZF	041510 KS	Sun Jung Lee
	Tencent Music	TME	TME US	Alex Liu
	Tencent Music	TCMEF	1698 HK	Alex Liu
	Urban Company	XURBF	URBANCO IN	Sachin Salgaonkar
	Weimob	WEMXF	2013 HK	Daley Li, CFA
	WiseTech Global Limited	WTC HF	WTC AU	Sriharsh Singh
	YG Entertainment	XYEIF	122870 KS	Sun Jung Lee
	Yonyou Network	XYNIF	600588 CH	Daley Li, CFA

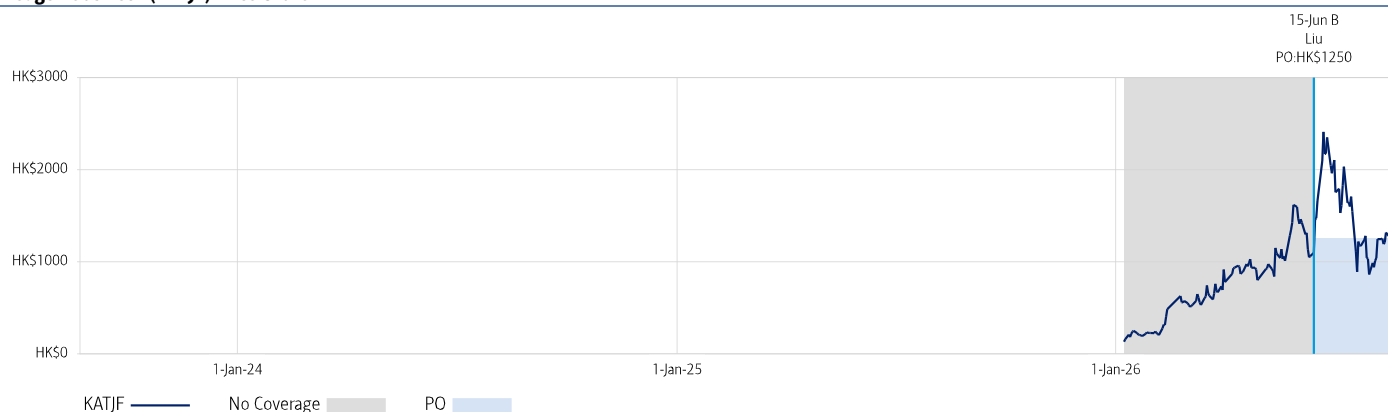
UNDERPERFORM

	Autohome	ATHM	ATHM US	Miranda Zhuang, CFA
	Autohome	XXYZF	2518 HK	Miranda Zhuang, CFA
	DBAPPSecurity	XDBAF	688023 CH	Daley Li, CFA
	Glodon Company	XGCOF	002410 CH	Daley Li, CFA
	NavInfo	XWLHF	002405 CH	Daley Li, CFA
	Ping An Healthcare and Technology	PANHF	1833 HK	Miranda Zhuang, CFA
	Qi An Xin	XQTDF	688561 CH	Daley Li, CFA
	Technology One Limited	THNOF	TNE AU	Ware Kuo
	ThunderSoft	XSTS F	300496 CH	Daley Li, CFA
	Venustech	XVCGF	002439 CH	Daley Li, CFA
	Weibo Corporation	WB	WB US	Miranda Zhuang, CFA
	Weibo Corporation	WEIBF	9898 HK	Miranda Zhuang, CFA

Disclosures

Important Disclosures

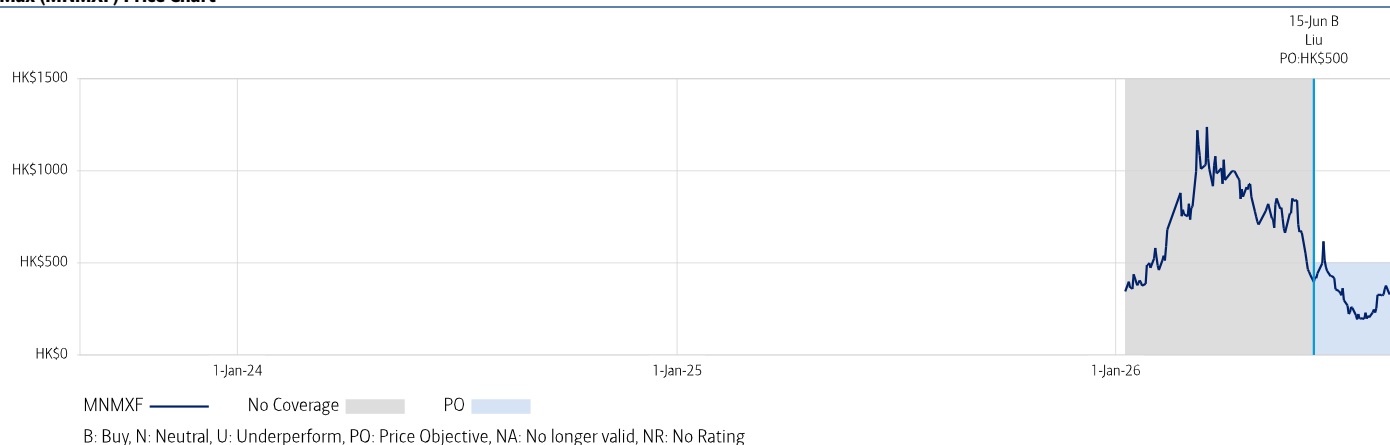
Knowledge Atlas Tech (KATJF) Price Chart



B: Buy, N: Neutral, U: Underperform, PO: Price Objective, NA: No longer valid, NR: No Rating

The Investment Opinion System is contained at the end of the report under the heading "Fundamental Equity Opinion Key". Dark grey shading indicates the security is restricted with the opinion suspended. Medium grey shading indicates the security is under review with the opinion withdrawn. Light grey shading indicates the security is not covered. Chart is current as of a date no more than one trading day prior to the date of the report.

MiniMax (MNMXF) Price Chart



The Investment Opinion System is contained at the end of the report under the heading "Fundamental Equity Opinion Key". Dark grey shading indicates the security is restricted with the opinion suspended. Medium grey shading indicates the security is under review with the opinion withdrawn. Light grey shading indicates the security is not covered. Chart is current as of a date no more than one trading day prior to the date of the report.

Equity Investment Rating Distribution: Technology Group (as of 30 Jun 2026)

Coverage Universe	Count	Percent	Inv. Banking Relationships ^{R1}	Count	Percent
Buy	243	60.60%	Buy	123	50.62%
Hold	87	21.70%	Hold	45	51.72%
Sell	71	17.71%	Sell	21	29.58%

Equity Investment Rating Distribution: Global Group (as of 30 Jun 2026)

Coverage Universe	Count	Percent	Inv. Banking Relationships ^{R1}	Count	Percent
Buy	1987	56.11%	Buy	1190	59.89%
Hold	797	22.51%	Hold	496	62.23%
Sell	757	21.38%	Sell	391	51.65%

^{R1} Issuers that were investment banking clients of BofA Securities or one of its affiliates within the past 12 months. For purposes of this Investment Rating Distribution, the coverage universe includes only stocks. A stock rated Neutral is included as a Hold, and a stock rated Underperform is included as a Sell.

FUNDAMENTAL EQUITY OPINION KEY: Opinions include a Volatility Risk Rating, an Investment Rating and an Income Rating. **VOLATILITY RISK RATINGS**, indicators of potential price fluctuation, are: A - Low, B - Medium and C - High. **INVESTMENT RATINGS** reflect the analyst's assessment of both a stock's absolute total return potential as well as its attractiveness for investment relative to other stocks within its Coverage Cluster (defined below). Our investment ratings are: 1 - Buy stocks are expected to have a total return of at least 10% and are the most attractive stocks in the coverage cluster; 2 - Neutral stocks are expected to remain flat or increase in value and are less attractive than Buy rated stocks and 3 - Underperform stocks are the least attractive stocks in a coverage cluster. An investment rating of 6 (No Rating) indicates that a stock is no longer trading on the basis of fundamentals. Analysts assign investment ratings considering, among other things, the 0-12 month total return expectation for a stock and the firm's guidelines for ratings dispersions (shown in the table below). The current price objective for a stock should be referenced to better understand the total return expectation at any given time. The price objective reflects the analyst's view of the potential price appreciation (depreciation).

Investment rating	Total return expectation (within 12-month period of date of initial rating)	Ratings dispersion guidelines for coverage cluster ^{R2}
Buy	≥ 10%	≤ 70%
Neutral	≥ 0%	≤ 30%
Underperform	N/A	≥ 20%

^{R2} Ratings dispersions may vary from time to time where BofA Global Research believes it better reflects the investment prospects of stocks in a Coverage Cluster.

INCOME RATINGS, indicators of potential cash dividends, are: 7 - same/higher (dividend considered to be secure), 8 - same/lower (dividend not considered to be secure) and 9 - pays no cash dividend. **Coverage Cluster** is comprised of stocks covered by a single analyst or two or more analysts sharing a common industry, sector, region or other classification(s). A stock's coverage cluster is included in the most recent BofA Global Research report referencing the stock.

Price Charts for the securities referenced in this research report are available on the [Price Charts website](#), or call 1-800-MERRILL to have them mailed.

In the US, retail sales and/or distribution of this report may be made only in states where these securities are exempt from registration or have been qualified for sale: Knowledge Atlas Tech, MiniMax.

BofAS together with its affiliates beneficially owns one percent or more of the common stock of this issuer. If this report was issued on or after the 9th day of the month, it reflects the ownership position on the last day of the previous month. Reports issued before the 9th day of a month reflect the ownership position at the end of the second month preceding the date of the report: MiniMax.

BofA Global Research personnel (including the analyst(s) responsible for this report) receive compensation based upon, among other factors, the overall profitability of Bank of America Corporation, including profits derived from investment banking. The analyst(s) responsible for this report may also receive compensation based upon, among other factors, the overall profitability of the Bank's sales and trading businesses relating to the class of securities or financial instruments for which such analyst is responsible.

Other Important Disclosures

From time to time research analysts conduct site visits of covered issuers. BofA Global Research policies prohibit research analysts from accepting payment or reimbursement for travel expenses from the issuer for such visits.

Prices are indicative and for information purposes only. Except as otherwise stated in the report, for any recommendation in relation to an equity security, the price referenced is the publicly traded price of the security as of close of business on the day prior to the date of the report or, if the report is published during intraday trading, the price referenced is indicative of the traded

price as of the date and time of the report and in relation to a debt security (including equity preferred and CDS), prices are indicative as of the date and time of the report and are from various sources including BofA Securities trading desks.

The date and time of completion of the production of any recommendation in this report shall be the date and time of dissemination of this report as recorded in the report timestamp.

Recipients who are not institutional investors or market professionals should seek the advice of their independent financial advisor before considering information in this report in connection with any investment decision, or for a necessary explanation of its contents.

Officers of BofA or one or more of its affiliates (other than research analysts) may have a financial interest in securities of the issuer(s) or in related investments.

Refer to [BofA Global Research policies relating to conflicts of interest](#).

"BofA Securities" includes BofA Securities, Inc. ("BofAS") and its affiliates. Investors should contact their BofA Securities representative or Merrill Global Wealth Management financial advisor if they have questions concerning this report or concerning the appropriateness of any investment idea described herein for such investor. "BofA Securities" is a global brand for BofA Global Research.

Information relating to Non-US affiliates of BofA Securities and Distribution of Affiliate Research Reports:

BofAS and/or Merrill Lynch, Pierce, Fenner & Smith Incorporated ("MLPF&S") may in the future distribute, information of the following non-US affiliates in the US (short name: legal name, regulator): Merrill Lynch (South Africa): Merrill Lynch South Africa (Pty) Ltd., regulated by the Financial Sector Conduct Authority; MLI (UK): Merrill Lynch International, regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA); BofASE (France): BofA Securities Europe SA is authorized by the Autorité de Contrôle Prudentiel et de Résolution (ACPR) and regulated by the ACPR and the Autorité des Marchés Financiers (AMF). BofA Securities Europe SA ("BofASE") with registered address at 51, rue La Boétie, 75008 Paris is registered under no 842 602 690 RCS Paris. In accordance with the provisions of French Code Monétaire et Financier (Monetary and Financial Code), BofASE is an établissement de crédit et d'investissement (credit and investment institution) that is authorised and supervised by the European Central Bank and the Autorité de Contrôle Prudentiel et de Résolution (ACPR) and regulated by the ACPR and the Autorité des Marchés Financiers. BofASE's share capital can be found at www.bofam.com/BofASEdisclaimer; BofA Europe (Milan): Bank of America Europe Designated Activity Company, Milan Branch, regulated by the Bank of Italy, the European Central Bank (ECB) and the Central Bank of Ireland (CBI); BofA Europe (Frankfurt): Bank of America Europe Designated Activity Company, Frankfurt Branch regulated by BaFin, the ECB and the CBI; BofA Europe (Zurich): Bank of America Europe Designated Activity Company, Zurich Branch, regulated by the Swiss Financial Market Supervisory Authority FINMA, the ECB and CBI; BofA Europe (Madrid): Bank of America Europe Designated Activity Company, Sucursal en España, regulated by the Bank of Spain, the ECB and the CBI; Merrill Lynch (Australia): Merrill Lynch Equities (Australia) Limited, regulated by the Australian Securities and Investments Commission; Merrill Lynch (Hong Kong): Merrill Lynch (Asia Pacific) Limited, regulated by the Hong Kong Securities and Futures Commission (HKSF); Merrill Lynch (Singapore): Merrill Lynch (Singapore) Pte Ltd, regulated by the Monetary Authority of Singapore (MAS); Merrill Lynch (Canada): Merrill Lynch Canada Inc, regulated by the Canadian Investment Regulatory Organization; Merrill Lynch (Mexico): Merrill Lynch Mexico, SA de CV, Casa de Bolsa, regulated by the Comisión Nacional Bancaria y de Valores; BofAS Japan: BofA Securities Japan Co., Ltd., regulated by the Financial Services Agency; Merrill Lynch (Seoul): Merrill Lynch International, LLC Seoul Branch, regulated by the Financial Supervisory Service; Merrill Lynch (Taiwan): Merrill Lynch Securities (Taiwan) Ltd., regulated by the Securities and Futures Bureau; BofAS India: BofA Securities India Limited, regulated by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI); Merrill Lynch (Israel): Merrill Lynch Israel Limited, regulated by Israel Securities Authority; Merrill Lynch (DIFC): Merrill Lynch International (DIFC Branch), regulated by the Dubai Financial Services Authority (DFSA); Merrill Lynch (Brazil): Merrill Lynch S.A. Corretora de Títulos e Valores Mobiliários, regulated by Comissão de Valores Mobiliários; Merrill Lynch KSA Company: Merrill Lynch Kingdom of Saudi Arabia Company, regulated by the Capital Market Authority. This information: has been approved for publication and is distributed in the United Kingdom (UK) to professional clients and eligible counterparties (as each is defined in the rules of the FCA and the PRA) by MLI (UK), which is authorized by the PRA and regulated by the FCA and the PRA - details about the extent of our regulation by the FCA and PRA are available from us on request; has been approved for publication and is distributed in the European Economic Area (EEA) by BofASE (France), which is authorized by the ACPR and regulated by the ACPR and the AMF; has been considered and distributed in Japan by BofAS Japan, a registered securities dealer under the Financial Instruments and Exchange Act in Japan, or its permitted affiliates; is issued and distributed in Hong Kong by Merrill Lynch (Hong Kong) which is regulated by HKSF; is issued and distributed in Taiwan by Merrill Lynch (Taiwan); is issued and distributed in India by BofAS India; and is issued and distributed in Singapore to institutional investors and/or accredited investors (each as defined under the Financial Advisers Regulations) by Merrill Lynch (Singapore) (Company Registration No 198602883D). Merrill Lynch (Singapore) is regulated by MAS. Merrill Lynch Equities (Australia) Limited (ABN 65 006 276 795), AFS License 235132 (MLEA) distributes this information in Australia only to 'Wholesale' clients as defined by s.761G of the Corporations Act 2001. With the exception of Bank of America N.A., Australia Branch, neither MLEA nor any of its affiliates involved in preparing this information is an Authorised Deposit-Taking Institution under the Banking Act 1959 nor regulated by the Australian Prudential Regulation Authority. No approval is required for publication or distribution of this information in Brazil and its local distribution is by Merrill Lynch (Brazil) in accordance with applicable regulations. Merrill Lynch (DIFC) is authorized and regulated by the DFSA. Information prepared and issued by Merrill Lynch (DIFC) is done so in accordance with the requirements of the DFSA conduct of business rules. BofA Europe (Frankfurt) distributes this information in Germany and is regulated by BaFin, the ECB and the CBI. BofA Securities entities, including BofA Europe and BofASE (France), may outsource/delegate the marketing and/or provision of certain research services or aspects of research services to other branches or members of the BofA Securities group. You may be contacted by a different BofA Securities entity acting for and on behalf of your service provider where permitted by applicable law. This does not change your service provider. Please refer to the [Electronic Communications Disclaimers](#) for further information.

This information has been prepared and issued by BofAS and/or one or more of its non-US affiliates. The author(s) of this information may not be licensed to carry on regulated activities in your jurisdiction and, if not licensed, do not hold themselves out as being able to do so. BofAS and/or MLPF&S is the distributor of this information in the US and accepts full responsibility for information distributed to BofAS and/or MLPF&S clients in the US by its non-US affiliates. Any US person receiving this information and wishing to effect any transaction in any security discussed herein should do so through BofAS and/or MLPF&S and not such foreign affiliates. Hong Kong recipients of this information should contact Merrill Lynch (Asia Pacific) Limited in respect of any matters relating to dealing in securities or provision of specific advice on securities or any other matters arising from, or in connection with, this information. Singapore recipients of this information should contact Merrill Lynch (Singapore) Pte Ltd in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this information. For clients that are not accredited investors, expert investors or institutional investors Merrill Lynch (Singapore) Pte Ltd accepts full responsibility for the contents of this information distributed to such clients in Singapore.

General Investment Related Disclosures:

Taiwan Readers: Neither the information nor any opinion expressed herein constitutes an offer or a solicitation of an offer to transact in any securities or other financial instrument. No part of this report may be used or reproduced or quoted in any manner whatsoever in Taiwan by the press or any other person without the express written consent of BofA Securities. This document provides general information only, and has been prepared for, and is intended for general distribution to, BofA Securities clients. Neither the information nor any opinion expressed constitutes an offer or an invitation to make an offer, to buy or sell any securities or other financial instrument or any derivative related to such securities or instruments (e.g., options, futures, warrants, and contracts for differences). This document is not intended to provide personal investment advice and it does not take into account the specific investment objectives, financial situation and the particular needs of, and is not directed to, any specific person(s). This document and its content do not constitute, and should not be considered to constitute, investment advice for purposes of ERISA, the US tax code, the Investment Advisers Act or otherwise. Investors should seek financial advice regarding the appropriateness of investing in financial instruments and implementing investment strategies discussed or recommended in this document and should understand that statements regarding future prospects may not be realized. Any decision to purchase or subscribe for securities in any offering must be based solely on existing public information on such security or the information in the prospectus or other offering document issued in connection with such offering, and not on this document.

Securities and other financial instruments referred to herein, or recommended, offered or sold by BofA Securities, are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation and are not deposits or other obligations of any insured depository institution (including, Bank of America, N.A.). Investments in general and, derivatives, in particular, involve numerous risks, including, among others, market risk, counterparty default risk and liquidity risk. No security, financial instrument or derivative is suitable for all investors. Digital assets are extremely speculative, volatile and are largely unregulated. In some cases, securities and other financial instruments may be difficult to value or sell and reliable information about the value or risks related to the security or financial instrument may be difficult to obtain. Investors should note that income from such securities and other financial instruments, if any, may fluctuate and that price or value of such securities and instruments may rise or fall and, in some cases, investors may lose their entire principal investment. Past performance is not necessarily a guide to future performance. Levels and basis for taxation may change.

This report may contain a short-term trading idea or recommendation, which highlights a specific near-term catalyst or event impacting the issuer or the market that is anticipated to have a short-term price impact on the equity securities of the issuer. Short-term trading ideas and recommendations are different from and do not affect a stock's fundamental equity rating, which reflects both a longer term total return expectation and attractiveness for investment relative to other stocks within its Coverage Cluster. Short-term trading ideas and recommendations may be more or less positive than a stock's fundamental equity rating.

BofA Securities is aware that the implementation of the ideas expressed in this report may depend upon an investor's ability to "short" securities or other financial instruments and that such action may be limited by regulations prohibiting or restricting "shortselling" in many jurisdictions. Investors are urged to seek advice regarding the applicability of such regulations prior to

executing any short idea contained in this report.

Foreign currency rates of exchange may adversely affect the value, price or income of any security or financial instrument mentioned herein. Investors in such securities and instruments, including ADRs, effectively assume currency risk.

BofAS or one of its affiliates is a regular issuer of traded financial instruments linked to securities that may have been recommended in this report. BofAS or one of its affiliates may, at any time, hold a trading position (long or short) in the securities and financial instruments discussed in this report.

BofA Securities, through business units other than BofA Global Research, may have issued and may in the future issue trading ideas or recommendations that are inconsistent with, and reach different conclusions from, the information presented herein. Such ideas or recommendations may reflect different time frames, assumptions, views and analytical methods of the persons who prepared them, and BofA Securities is under no obligation to ensure that such other trading ideas or recommendations are brought to the attention of any recipient of this information.

In the event that the recipient received this information pursuant to a contract between the recipient and BofAS for the provision of research services for a separate fee, and in connection therewith BofAS may be deemed to be acting as an investment adviser, such status relates, if at all, solely to the person with whom BofAS has contracted directly and does not extend beyond the delivery of this report (unless otherwise agreed specifically in writing by BofAS). If such recipient uses the services of BofAS in connection with the sale or purchase of a security referred to herein, BofAS may act as principal for its own account or as agent for another person. BofAS is and continues to act solely as a broker-dealer in connection with the execution of any transactions, including transactions in any securities referred to herein.

Copyright and General Information:

Copyright 2026 Bank of America Corporation. All rights reserved. iQDatabase® is a registered service mark of Bank of America Corporation. This information is prepared for the use of BofA Securities clients and may not be redistributed, retransmitted or disclosed, in whole or in part, or in any form or manner, without the express written consent of BofA Securities. This document and its content is provided solely for informational purposes and cannot be used for training or developing artificial intelligence (AI) models or as an input in any AI application (collectively, an AI tool). Any attempt to utilize this document or any of its content in connection with an AI tool without explicit written permission from BofA Global Research is strictly prohibited. BofA Global Research utilizes AI, including machine learning and other technologies, to enhance the services we provide to our clients. These technologies assist our analysts in various aspects of their work, including but not limited to data analysis, content extraction, content creation, data aggregation and summarization and identifying relevant information from diverse sources. All AI-driven processes are subject to review by BofA Global Research employees. BofA Global Research information is distributed simultaneously to internal and client websites and other portals by BofA Securities and is not publicly-available material. Any unauthorized use or disclosure is prohibited. Receipt and review of this information constitutes your agreement not to redistribute, retransmit, or disclose to others the contents, opinions, conclusion, or information contained herein (including any investment recommendations, estimates or price targets) without first obtaining express permission from an authorized officer of BofA Securities.

Materials prepared by BofA Global Research personnel are based on public information. Facts and views presented in this material have not been reviewed by, and may not reflect information known to, professionals in other business areas of BofA Securities, including investment banking personnel. BofA Securities has established information barriers between BofA Global Research and certain business groups. As a result, BofA Securities does not disclose certain client relationships with, or compensation received from, such issuers. To the extent this material discusses any legal proceeding or issues, it has not been prepared as nor is it intended to express any legal conclusion, opinion or advice. Investors should consult their own legal advisers as to issues of law relating to the subject matter of this material. BofA Global Research personnel's knowledge of legal proceedings in which any BofA Securities entity and/or its directors, officers and employees may be plaintiffs, defendants, co-defendants or co-plaintiffs with or involving issuers mentioned in this material is based on public information. Facts and views presented in this material that relate to any such proceedings have not been reviewed by, discussed with, and may not reflect information known to, professionals in other business areas of BofA Securities in connection with the legal proceedings or matters relevant to such proceedings.

This information has been prepared independently of any issuer of securities mentioned herein and not in connection with any proposed offering of securities or as agent of any issuer of any securities. None of BofAS any of its affiliates or their research analysts has any authority whatsoever to make any representation or warranty on behalf of the issuer(s). BofA Global Research policy prohibits research personnel from disclosing a recommendation, investment rating, or investment thesis for review by an issuer prior to the publication of a research report containing such rating, recommendation or investment thesis.

Any information relating to sustainability in this material is limited as discussed herein and is not intended to provide a comprehensive view on any sustainability claim with respect to any issuer or security.

Any information relating to the tax status of financial instruments discussed herein is not intended to provide tax advice or to be used by anyone to provide tax advice. Investors are urged to seek tax advice based on their particular circumstances from an independent tax professional.

The information herein (other than disclosure information relating to BofA Securities and its affiliates) was obtained from various sources and we do not guarantee its accuracy. This information may contain links to third-party websites. BofA Securities is not responsible for the content of any third-party website or any linked content contained in a third-party website. Content contained on such third-party websites is not part of this information and is not incorporated by reference. The inclusion of a link does not imply any endorsement by or any affiliation with BofA Securities. Access to any third-party website is at your own risk, and you should always review the terms and privacy policies at third-party websites before submitting any personal information to them. BofA Securities is not responsible for such terms and privacy policies and expressly disclaims any liability for them.

All opinions, projections and estimates constitute the judgment of the author as of the date of publication and are subject to change without notice. Prices also are subject to change without notice. BofA Securities is under no obligation to update this information and BofA Securities ability to publish information on the subject issuer(s) in the future is subject to applicable quiet periods. You should therefore assume that BofA Securities will not update any fact, circumstance or opinion contained herein.

Subject to the quiet period applicable under laws of the various jurisdictions in which we distribute research reports and other legal and BofA Securities policy-related restrictions on the publication of research reports, fundamental equity reports are produced on a regular basis as necessary to keep the investment recommendation current.

Certain outstanding reports or investment opinions relating to securities, financial instruments and/or issuers may no longer be current. Always refer to the most recent research report relating to an issuer prior to making an investment decision.

In some cases, an issuer may be classified as Restricted or may be Under Review or Extended Review. In each case, investors should consider any investment opinion relating to such issuer (or its security and/or financial instruments) to be suspended or withdrawn and should not rely on the analyses and investment opinion(s) pertaining to such issuer (or its securities and/or financial instruments) nor should the analyses or opinion(s) be considered a solicitation of any kind. Sales persons and financial advisors affiliated with BofAS or any of its affiliates may not solicit purchases of securities or financial instruments that are Restricted or Under Review and may only solicit securities under Extended Review in accordance with firm policies.

Neither BofA Securities nor any officer or employee of BofA Securities accepts any liability whatsoever for any direct, indirect or consequential damages or losses arising from any use of this information.